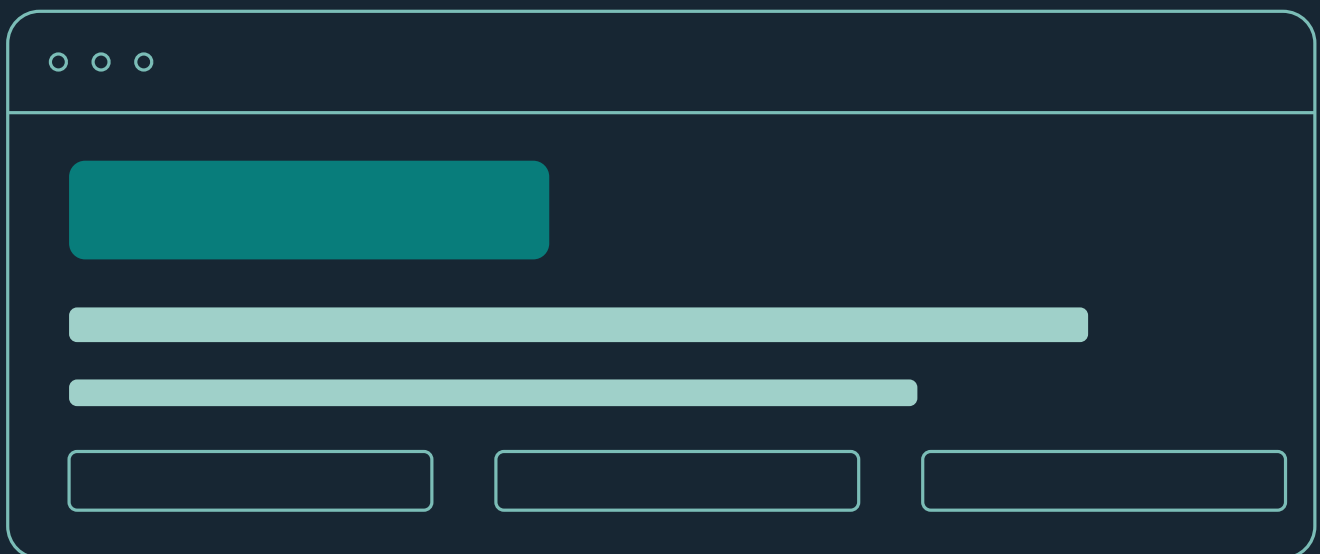


WordPress Website Development

A practical guide to planning, building, launching and maintaining a professional website with the WordPress block editor.



START HERE

What you will build

This is a project-based guide. Follow the running example: a five-page website for an illustrative Surat-based service business. Replace every sample detail with your own or a client's verified information.

OUTPUT	WHAT IT CONTAINS
A working site	Home, Services, About, FAQ and Contact pages; clear navigation and mobile layout.
A reliable setup	Domain, hosting, HTTPS, backups, updates and restricted user access.
A launch system	Function, accessibility, search visibility and performance checks.
A handoff pack	Credentials plan, change log and maintenance routine.

How to use the book

- 1 Complete the short worksheet before touching a theme.
- 2 Build one page at a time using the same content-first method.
- 3 Run the launch checklist on a phone and a desktop browser.
- 4 Keep the final templates for your own site or client projects.

REALITY CHECK

A published site does not guarantee traffic, enquiries or sales. Hosting, theme and plugin terms change. Check current provider details before buying, and test the real site before relying on it.

CONTENTS

Your route through the project

STAGE	PAGES	DELIVERABLE
01 Plan	04-07	Brief, platform choice, site map and stack
02 Build	08-14	Install, configure, edit and write core pages
03 Improve	15-18	Accessibility, security, SEO and speed
04 Publish	19-22	QA, handoff, maintenance and fixes
05 Apply	23-28	30-day plan, assets, sources and closing

The workflow



A useful definition of “done”

A site is ready when a visitor can understand the offer, navigate the pages, contact the business, and use it on a small screen; and the owner can maintain it without guessing.

KEEP THIS IN MIND

The dashboard labels can differ by theme, plugins and WordPress version. This guide uses a block theme and the native Site Editor as the default route.

01 / PLAN

Write the site brief first

Illustrative project: “Studio North” offers brand photography in Surat. It is fictional; the copy and contact details in this book are examples, not a real business.

DECISION	WORKING ANSWER
Primary audience	Local businesses that need product and team photographs.
One main action	Request a quote through the contact form.
Secondary action	View sample work and service details.
Proof available	Only genuine portfolio images, client permission and real reviews.
Site boundary	Five pages; no online payments or booking system in version one.

Brief worksheet

- ☐ Business name and verified contact details: _____
- ☐ Audience and their main question: _____
- ☐ Main action and destination page: _____
- ☐ Services, service area and exclusions: _____
- ☐ Existing logo, images, proof and permissions: _____
- ☐ Who approves copy, owns domain and receives form submissions: _____

DECISION RULE

If you cannot explain the main offer and next action in one sentence each, pause the build and clarify the brief. A theme cannot solve unclear positioning.

01 / PLAN

Choose the right WordPress route

ROUTE	BEST WHEN	TRADE-OFF
WordPress.org software on your hosting	You want control of hosting, themes, plugins and data arrangements.	You arrange hosting, updates, backups and support.
WordPress.com hosted service	You want a managed entry point and prefer platform support.	Capabilities vary by plan; check current terms before purchasing.

This book's route

The step-by-step build uses self-hosted WordPress with a block theme. Ask a prospective host about current WordPress requirements, HTTPS, backups, restore support, server location, renewal terms and support response. Confirm domain renewal and who legally controls the account.

Costs to verify before purchase

- ☐ Domain registration and renewal, including taxes.
- ☐ Hosting intro price versus renewal price; storage and traffic limits.
- ☐ Email mailbox, backup retention, staging and restore charges.
- ☐ Theme or plugin licenses, number of sites and renewal terms.
- ☐ Payment gateway terms if you later add checkout.

INDIA-FIRST NOTE

For an Indian business, keep domain and hosting invoices in the business's name where possible. Tax, privacy and invoice obligations depend on the setup; check current official guidance or a qualified professional.

01 / PLAN

Map the site before designing

Five-page starter architecture

PAGE	ONE JOB	PRIMARY ACTION
Home	Explain the offer and direct visitors.	Explore services / request quote
Services	Describe scope, process and fit.	Request quote
About	Show the team and authentic proof.	Contact
FAQ	Resolve common buying questions.	Contact
Contact	Make enquiry easy and reliable.	Submit form / call

Navigation test

Use short labels in the same order as the visitor's questions. Keep a visible Contact action. Avoid adding empty pages just to make a menu feel larger.

Content inventory

- Logo and brand colors; service descriptions; approved images with usage rights.
- Real business name, address or service area, email and phone.
- Proof you can substantiate: portfolio samples, qualifications, process and testimonials with permission.
- Privacy notice and other business disclosures appropriate to the actual site.

SCOPE CONTROL

For version one, list every requested feature as Essential, Later or Not needed. A booking, shop or multilingual setup is a separate workflow with additional testing.

01 / PLAN

Pick a small, maintainable stack

LAYER	STARTING CHOICE	EVALUATION
Theme	A maintained block theme from the WordPress directory.	Preview on mobile; check updates, accessibility and editor patterns.
Pages	Native block editor and Site Editor.	Can the owner change text, images and navigation?
Forms	One reputable form plugin if needed.	Delivery, spam controls, data handling and maintenance.
SEO	Core features first; optional SEO plugin for advanced controls.	Avoid overlapping sitemap/meta functions.
Backup	Host backup plus an independent copy where practical.	Prove that a restore actually works.

Plugin decision card

- ☐ Does WordPress or the host already provide this function?
- ☐ Is the plugin compatible with your current WordPress/PHP setup?
- ☐ Is it maintained, documented and actively supported?
- ☐ Can you explain the data it collects and where it goes?
- ☐ Does it create duplicate scripts or conflict with an existing plugin?

RECOMMENDATION

Install only what the site needs. More plugins are not automatically unsafe, but every extra component adds an update and compatibility obligation.

02 / BUILD

Install and lock down the basics

- 1 Register the domain in an account the site owner controls. Point DNS to the host using its current instructions. Allow DNS changes time to propagate.
- 2 Create the hosting account, enable HTTPS and use the host's WordPress installer or the official manual installation guide.
- 3 Create a unique administrator username and strong password. Turn on multifactor authentication where the host or login setup supports it.
- 4 Open the site and /wp-admin over HTTPS. Check both load without a certificate warning.
- 5 Record host, domain, DNS, backup location and renewal dates in a private handoff document.

Immediate checks

- ☐ Settings > General: site title, tagline, site URL and admin email are correct.
- ☐ Settings > Reading: decide whether a static page will be the homepage.
- ☐ Settings > Permalinks: choose a readable structure before sharing URLs.
- ☐ Tools > Site Health: review critical issues and host configuration.

DO NOT COPY CREDENTIALS INTO THE EBOOK

For client work, transfer access through an agreed secure method; give each person their own account and role.

02 / BUILD

Set the dashboard for clean publishing

Pages, posts and templates

ITEM	USE IT FOR
Page	Stable content such as Home, Services, About and Contact.
Post	Dated articles or updates when the site actually needs them.
Template	Shared layout controlling how a type of page is displayed.
Pattern	Reusable block layout you can insert and adapt.

First setup pass

- 1 Create all five pages as drafts. Use a clear page title for each.
- 2 In Settings > Reading, select a static homepage and assign Home; choose a posts page only if publishing articles.
- 3 With a block theme, open Appearance > Editor to edit site-wide styles, templates, header, footer and navigation.
- 4 Build one header and one footer. Include business identity, useful links and verified contact details.
- 5 Preview each draft in desktop and mobile widths before publication.

THEME DISTINCTION

Appearance > Editor is available with an active block theme. A classic theme may present Customizer and different navigation controls.

02 / BUILD

Use blocks without losing control

A dependable editing loop

Insert a block with “+” or slash search; choose its content; adjust alignment and spacing; preview the page; then check it on a phone. Use Group and Columns for structure, not extra blank paragraphs for spacing.

BLOCK	GOOD USE	WATCH FOR
Heading	One page topic, clear sections.	Skipping levels for visual size.
Paragraph / List	Readable explanations and steps.	Long unbroken walls of text.
Image	Real work, team or relevant visual.	Huge files, missing alt context.
Buttons	A clear next action.	Vague “Click here” labels.
Columns / Group	Related cards or sections.	Awkward mobile stacking.

Editing rule

Set type, colors and global spacing in Styles when possible. Make local overrides only when a section needs them. This keeps later changes manageable.

PRACTICE

Build a three-part hero: a specific headline, one-sentence explanation and one Request a Quote button. Preview at narrow width before adding more decoration.

02 / BUILD

Write the homepage as a journey

Wireframe: from question to action

ORDER	SECTION	WHAT TO SAY
1	Hero	Who it is for, what you do, where, and next action.
2	Service snapshot	Three service categories with links to details.
3	Why choose this business	Specific process or verifiable differentiators.
4	Proof	Approved samples, team details or genuine reviews.
5	Process / FAQ	What happens after the enquiry.
6	Final action	Simple contact prompt and expected response channel.

Illustrative copy

HERO DRAFT

Brand photographs for Surat businesses. Show products, people and spaces clearly with a planned shoot and edited images. [Request a quote] [View services]

Rewrite exercise

Replace broad claims (“best quality”) with a concrete description. For every section, ask: What does the visitor need to know before taking the next step?

02 / BUILD

Build a useful Services page

One service card formula

FIELD	PROMPT
Name	Use the phrase the customer would recognize.
Outcome	What will they receive? Avoid promising business results.
Scope	What is included and what is excluded?
Process	What information do you need, and what happens next?
CTA	Where does the enquiry go?

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE

Product photography | Planned product images for catalogs and web pages. Scope and deliverables depend on the brief. Share product count, reference style, location and deadline to request a quote.

About and FAQ pages

- About: identify the people or business, explain the process, show real work and give a contact route.
- FAQ: answer practical questions such as service area, preparation, turnaround discussion and how quotes are prepared. Do not invent fixed timelines.
- Link naturally to Contact where a question requires a specific quote.

02 / BUILD

Make contact work end to end

Contact page essentials

- ☐ Show a verified email or phone and service area.
- ☐ Keep form fields to what is needed: name, contact, service and message.
- ☐ Add a clear submit label and a useful success message.
- ☐ Send notifications to a monitored inbox; test delivery and spam folder.
- ☐ Explain how enquiry data is handled in a suitable privacy notice.

Form test script

- 1 Submit a real test message from a phone with a distinct subject.
- 2 Check validation when a required field is empty and when email is invalid.
- 3 Confirm the on-page success state and the inbox notification.
- 4 Reply to the enquiry from the intended business mailbox.
- 5 Repeat after changing form, SMTP, caching or security settings.

WHATSAPP LINK

If the business uses WhatsApp, link to its verified number and check the mobile and desktop behavior. A chat link can complement the form, but it does not prove the form works.

02 / BUILD

Create a restrained design system

TOKEN	STARTING RULE
Color	One accent for actions; deep text on a light surface.
Type	One headline family and one readable body family.
Spacing	Use a repeatable scale; keep consistent section gaps.
Buttons	One primary style with a clear text label.
Imagery	Use relevant licensed or owned images; keep a consistent crop approach.

Page rhythm

- Lead with the main answer; follow with detail, proof and a next action.
- Use headings that describe the section instead of decorative slogans.
- Limit line length and avoid placing long paragraphs in narrow columns.
- Use contrast and whitespace to group related information.

WORDPRESS IMPLEMENTATION

Set global typography, colors and layout in Appearance > Editor > Styles for a block theme. The available controls depend on the theme.

03 / IMPROVE

Design for mobile and accessibility

Small-screen review

- ☐ No horizontal scrolling at common phone widths.
- ☐ Navigation opens, closes and can be operated by keyboard.
- ☐ Text remains readable without zoom; buttons are easy to distinguish.
- ☐ Columns stack in an intentional order; forms fit the screen.
- ☐ Images do not hide important text or create sudden layout jumps.

Accessibility pass

- Use a logical heading order and descriptive link/button names.
- Write alt text for informative images; decorative images do not need redundant descriptions.
- Ensure text contrast; do not signal meaning by color alone.
- Check keyboard focus and form labels/errors.
- Use real text instead of embedding essential copy in a poster image.

PRACTICAL TEST

Unplug the mouse for five minutes. Can you reach the menu, links and form in a sensible order using Tab, Enter and Shift+Tab?

03 / IMPROVE

Protect the site and its data

Minimum maintenance system

CONTROL	WHAT TO DO
Backups	Schedule files + database; store an independent copy when practical; test restoration.
Updates	Update WordPress, theme and plugins after a backup; inspect key pages afterward.
Access	Give each person the least privilege needed; remove unused accounts.
Login	Use unique strong passwords and available MFA.
Monitoring	Review Site Health, uptime and form delivery regularly.

Before a major update

- 1 Take a verified backup and record the current versions.
- 2 Use staging if the host offers it, especially for a live shop or custom build.
- 3 Update one layer at a time and test homepage, menu, form and checkout if applicable.
- 4 If something breaks, isolate the change and restore from a known good backup when needed.

ROLE REMINDER

Administrator access can change critical site settings. Use Editor or another suitable role for content-only work; inspect actual capabilities before assigning access.

03 / IMPROVE

Set up search foundations

A simple on-page method

- 1 Give each page a distinct purpose and descriptive title.
- 2 Write a clear main heading and sections that answer real visitor questions.
- 3 Use short descriptive URLs, internal links and meaningful image descriptions.
- 4 Check Settings > Reading so the live site is not asking search engines to avoid indexing.
- 5 Verify the site in Google Search Console and review indexing reports. Submit the sitemap if useful.

PAGE	QUERY INTENT	CONTENT TO INCLUDE
Services	Understand the offer	Scope, process, location and next step.
FAQ	Resolve concerns	Real answers to recurring questions.
Contact	Reach the business	Verified channels, area and form.

REALITY CHECK

A sitemap helps discovery but does not guarantee indexing or rankings. Search visibility depends on many factors; avoid promises of “page one.”

03 / IMPROVE

Measure and improve speed

Performance triage, in order

- 1 Test a representative page with PageSpeed Insights on mobile and desktop. Record the URL and date.
- 2 Compress and size images appropriately; avoid uploading print-sized originals for small page slots.
- 3 Remove unused plugins, fonts, sliders and external scripts.
- 4 Use host caching or a suitable caching setup, then retest the same page.
- 5 Check real device behavior; a synthetic score is a diagnostic, not the whole user experience.

What the metrics describe

METRIC	PLAIN ENGLISH
LCP	When the largest visible content appears.
INP	How promptly the page responds to interaction.
CLS	How much the layout shifts unexpectedly.

AVOID THE COMMON TRAP

Do not install several “speed” plugins at once. First find the slow asset or script, then change one thing and compare.

04 / PUBLISH

Run the launch checklist

AREA	PASS CONDITION
Content	No placeholder text; names, claims, prices and images approved.
Function	Menu, buttons, forms, phone and email links work.
Mobile	No clipping; readable type; sensible section order.
Trust	HTTPS, privacy information and real business details.
Search	Titles, URLs, index setting and Search Console checked.
Recovery	Backup exists and restore method is documented.

A 20-minute acceptance walk

- 1 Start at the homepage as a new visitor. Can you explain the offer in one sentence?
- 2 Find the right service, read the scope and reach Contact within a few taps.
- 3 Submit a test form and confirm delivery.
- 4 Repeat the journey on a phone using mobile data.
- 5 Capture issues in a list: URL, device, expected behavior, actual behavior, priority.

PUBLISH DELIBERATELY

Remove demo content and unused plugins/themes. Save a prelaunch backup; publish; then perform the acceptance walk again on the live domain.

04 / PUBLISH

Hand over without creating confusion

Client handoff pack

- ☐ Domain registrar and hosting owner; renewals and support contacts.
- ☐ WordPress administrator access transferred securely; named user roles.
- ☐ Theme and plugin list with license owner and renewal dates.
- ☐ Backup schedule, storage, restore steps and last restore test.
- ☐ How to edit text, add images and avoid editing shared templates accidentally.
- ☐ Form destination and test procedure.
- ☐ Known limitations and future work, clearly separated from completed scope.

A 15-minute training session

- 1 Ask the owner to edit a line of text and replace an image.
- 2 Show Preview versus Publish, and how to revert an accidental change.
- 3 Let them send a test enquiry and locate it.
- 4 Show where updates and Site Health appear.

FREELANCER PRACTICE

Agree in writing who owns the domain, hosting and paid licenses. Define what “launch” includes, revision rounds, maintenance scope and response expectations before building.

04 / PUBLISH

Maintain the site after launch

CADENCE	ROUTINE
Weekly	Test primary form, review backups and check for urgent updates.
Monthly	Review updates, broken links, mobile layout and content accuracy.
Quarterly	Perform a restore test, review users and assess stale content.
On change	Back up, document the edit, test affected pages and form.

Change log template

DATE	CHANGE	TEST / RESULT
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____

OWNER'S RULE

Treat the site as a maintained product. A forgotten form, expired domain or failed backup can undo careful design work.

04 / PUBLISH

Troubleshoot with a calm sequence

SYMPTOM	FIRST CHECK	NEXT STEP
Form sends nothing	Spam folder, recipient, submission log.	Test mail delivery and host configuration.
Page looks wrong	Recent edits, cache, mobile preview.	Clear relevant cache; compare prior revision.
Cannot log in	Correct URL, account, password reset.	Use host support and secure recovery.
Site is slow	Image sizes, scripts, host status.	Measure one URL; isolate changes.
Search page missing	Index setting, Search Console, URL.	Check crawl/index report and sitemap.

Issue ticket you can reuse

COPY-PASTE

URL: ___ Device/browser: ___ Time: ___ What I did: ___ Expected: ___ Actual: ___ Screenshot or error text: ___ Last change: ___

Recovery priority

If visitors cannot use the site, restore service first from a known good backup or host support. Diagnose the original cause after the site is stable.

05 / APPLY

Your 30-day build plan / days 1–15

DAY	TASK	PROOF OF COMPLETION
1–2	Write brief, audience and goal.	One-page brief approved.
3	Inventory content and permissions.	Asset list and gaps marked.
4	Define five-page site map.	Page jobs and CTAs written.
5	Choose hosting/domain and owner.	Accounts and renewals recorded.
6	Install WordPress and HTTPS.	Site and admin load securely.
7	Set title, reading and permalinks.	Settings screenshot or notes.
8	Pick a block theme and styles.	Global type/colors set.
9	Create draft pages and navigation.	Menu reaches every core page.
10–11	Write and build Home.	Mobile preview and CTA pass.
12–13	Build Services and About.	Scope and real proof checked.
14	Build FAQ.	Answers reviewed for accuracy.
15	Build Contact and test form.	Test enquiry reaches inbox.

TIME IS FLEXIBLE

The days are a learning schedule, not a promise of build time. Pause for client approvals, content gaps or technical support where needed.

05 / APPLY

Your 30-day build plan / days 16–30

DAY	TASK	PROOF OF COMPLETION
16–17	Check phone layout and keyboard use.	Issue list closed or tracked.
18	Optimize images and review scripts.	Before/after test recorded.
19	Set backup schedule and test restore.	Restore notes saved.
20	Review users, updates and Site Health.	Critical issues addressed.
21	Write titles, links and URLs.	Each page has a clear purpose.
22	Check privacy and business details.	Owner approves wording.
23–24	Run launch checklist and form test.	Acceptance notes complete.
25	Publish and retest live domain.	Mobile and desktop journeys pass.
26	Set up Search Console.	Property verified.
27–28	Prepare handoff and training.	Owner edits a page unaided.
29	Create maintenance calendar.	Owner assigned to each task.
30	Review and prioritize next iteration.	Three improvements with owners.

NEXT ITERATION EXAMPLES

Improve a confusing service page; replace weak imagery with approved real work; add a useful FAQ based on actual enquiries. Measure the relevant action before adding features.

05 / ASSETS

Copy-paste planning templates

One-page site brief

FILL IN

Business: ___ Audience: ___ Primary goal: ___ Main CTA: ___ Service area: ___ Core pages: ___ Approved proof: ___ Required integrations: ___ Domain owner: ___ Content approver: ___ Launch date: ___

Page content worksheet

FIELD	WRITE YOUR ANSWER
Page job	What question does this page answer?
Visitor worry	What may stop the next action?
Main heading	Specific, plain-language promise or topic.
Evidence	What approved material supports the claim?
Next action	Button text + destination.
Internal links	Which related page should the visitor see?

Hero copy formula

COPY-PASTE

[Specific service] for [audience] in [service area]. [One sentence about scope or process]. [Action button].
Verify every location and claim before publishing.

05 / ASSETS

Reusable review sheets

Homepage review

- ☐ Can a new visitor identify the offer, audience and area above the first long scroll?
- ☐ Is the primary action visible and repeated at a sensible point?
- ☐ Does each section answer a new question rather than repeat a claim?
- ☐ Are testimonials, logos and portfolio items genuine and permitted?

Prelaunch test record

TEST	RESULT / ISSUE
Desktop navigation	_____
Phone navigation	_____
Contact submission	_____
Email / call / chat links	_____
HTTPS and redirects	_____
Backup and restore	_____

Maintenance log

COPY-PASTE

Date: ____ Backup verified: ____ Updates applied: ____ Pages/forms tested: ____ Issue found: ____ Owner: ____
Next check: ____

REFERENCES

Sources & further reading

Official resources checked for this 2026 edition. Menus, requirements, terms and interfaces may change; confirm details at the source when you implement.

WordPress.org and WordPress.com

<https://wordpress.org/documentation/article/difference-between-wordpress-org-and-wordpress-com/>

WordPress requirements

<https://wordpress.org/about/requirements/>

Get started and installation

<https://wordpress.org/documentation/article/get-started-with-wordpress/>

Site Editor and block themes

<https://wordpress.org/documentation/article/site-editor/>

Block editor basics

<https://wordpress.org/documentation/article/work-with-blocks/>

Roles and capabilities

<https://wordpress.org/documentation/article/roles-and-capabilities/>

Updates and backups

<https://wordpress.org/documentation/article/updating-wordpress/>

Permalink settings

<https://wordpress.org/documentation/article/settings-permalinks-screen/>

Google SEO Starter Guide

<https://developers.google.com/search/docs/fundamentals/seo-starter-guide>

Google sitemap guidance

<https://developers.google.com/search/docs/crawling-indexing/sitemaps/build-sitemap>

Web Vitals guidance

<https://web.dev/articles/vitals>

EDITORIAL NOTE

The Studio North project and all sample copy are illustrative. This guide is educational, not legal or tax advice. For privacy, GST and business-specific compliance, consult current official guidance or a qualified professional.

THE NEXT STEP

Build something useful

A good website answers real questions, offers a clear next action and remains easy to maintain. Use the brief, publish the smallest complete version, then improve it from actual feedback.

YOUR FIRST ACTION

Write the one-page brief. Then create the five-page site map before opening the theme editor.

LEARNORA

LEARN TODAY. EARN TOMORROW.

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